JFC School Council Minutes

Monday, March 2, 2026, 7:00 - 8:30 pm, School Library or Online: Google Meet
meet.google.com/uhi-gkph-zhs

Present: Christine Caughill (VP), Amber Robertson (co-chair), Kylie Farmer, Susan Fryer-Davis (principal), Sarah Hildebrandt, Ashley Jardin, Christina Kropf (co-chair, notes), Philip Perivolaris, Bronwyn Fleming, Ashley North, Nancy Louwen (teacher rep), Stephanie Horsburg.

7:00 - 7:05 Welcome and Introductions
-everyone introduced themselves and their connection to JFC

7:05 - 7:30 WRAPSC Update - Ashley Jardin

- meeting update: Bill 33 presentation by committee member about the importance of advocacy
- In April the PIC will be providing an info night called “Let’s Grow”. Ashley J. will provide more information when provided
- Ashley will send a lunch and learn invitation to council by the WRDSB Psychology department with a focus on Bullying.
- WRAPSC meeting in April will be about AI. All council members are invited to join online or in person.
- Suggestions were given at the meeting on how to increase engagement within councils (increase council membership). Some suggestions were: have staff members present on the day to day happenings at school, what occurs during a staff meeting.
- Safe Caring and Inclusive Schools: all schools must have this committee. Susan indicated that more work is needed here at JFC to create this committee. **Susan is working on developing this and would be willing to do a presentation for council**.
- The Safe, Caring and Inclusive School Survey Results can be found here
- Ashley attended the Public Education Symposium which discussed Bill 33, decrease funding, changes with trustees, Ashley has forwarded information to the council as to how to advocate via calls, email. Ashley will forward more information if requested.

7:30 to 7:45 Pro Grant: Indigenous Learning Event - Amber

We had proposed to:

- Have Indigenous elders provide a teaching circle
- Invite KPL/Goodminds/or JFC library to come and set up books in the gym for kids regarding Indigenous peoples in Canada. Families can either purchase or borrow books depending on who hosts the books. Purchase books for JFC library
- Indigenous food tasting with Chef Destiny of Foodzen & Cedar Spoon Indigenous catering

The idea was to host an event with multiple elements (food, experience, learning, and community building). We applied for $1,650 dollars and received approval for $875 dollars.

Amber circulated an email to Council with an update that Crow Shield Lodge quote is $1,650 dollars and Chef Destiny is $400. In order to proceed with the event as planned an additional $1,175 dollars is needed.

- WRDSB Indigenous office recommended that we continue to work with Crow Shield Lodge and pay the requested rate and not negotiate a lower rate or reduced service.
- Council must decide how to proceed with this event as we cannot create a new proposal (grant now closed).
- Susan suggested there she could apply for some funding from the school board for Indigenous Education and that there is a partnership opportunity to include the ProGrant and the school to cohost the event in some form during the day and would involve all students. **Philip Perivolaris is willing to help. Susan will seek more information regarding the school board funding and connect with Philip about options.**
- **Amber will send grant materials to Phillip and Susan and any additional contacts to support the re-visioning of the event. A plan will be brought back to Council for approval and support.**

7:45 to 8:15 Chocolate Fundraising - Christina and Sarah

- Sarah has connected with Worlds Finest Chocolate Rep and determined that we will be having the same fundraiser as 2025. Bars 3 for $5. 20 sales per box (60 bars total). This option is favoured as profit is 50% per box **. Proposed Dates March 25 (Kick off Assembly that day)-April 9th (Wrap up)**
- In previous years, families have received a letter explaining the fundraiser with the option to "Opt Out" if they wish. If they did not return the letter it was assumed they had "Opted In".
- Susan expressed concern regarding the communication and letter to families and this fundraiser raises equity concerns. She had heard of a previous situation where some families thought it was a gift and were upset when they owed money. Concern was raised that many families do not speak English as their first language which could lead to confusion around the fundraiser.
- Susan indicated that she must approve all fundraising efforts of Council and in order to do the fundraiser we will use an "Opt In" approach, which is in line with the vision of the board to ensure an equity lens for all our school events.
- Sarah recommended to continue with the current "Opt out" selection as other schools who required students to "Opt in" see a significant loss in revenue. **Sarah will connect with chocolate rep to gather more information about this change of practice and potential implications.**

Suggestions were made to change the letter to:

- Clearly highlight the Opt in, Opt out, Donate options.
- Outline that unsold chocolate needs to be returned and money returned if chocolate sold
- Make the message more succinct.

Nancy volunteered to help Sarah with letter writing

Additional Suggestions were to:

- The group discussed ideas to improve communication including translation in other languages, simplifying communication, etc.

- Move the assembly and send the paper permission form home after assembly. (Previously opt out forms had been sent home before assembly and chocolate sent home day of assembly).
- Could Opt in form by provided School Day and Paper? **Susan to ask Penny**
- Could School Day product be used for small donation and link to WEFI for larger donations?

Council members to reach out to Christina or Sarah with prize ideas: Some suggestions are wireless earpods, amazon gift cards,

- **Outstanding: Identify the number of volunteers and roles needed (unable to discuss due to time constraint)**

deferred **Fundraising Update** **JFC School Council -2025/26 BUDGET**

- Deferred due to time constraint
- **All agreed Gino's pizza passive fundraiser to be in May. Ashley J will reach out to Ginos**

8:00 to 8:10 **Playground Update By Ashley North**

- Love my Hood grant: **Application is ready and being reviewed.** Due for March 5. We can apply in June if it's rejected
- Rick Hansen grant: **Alex recommended that installations should be done all at same time to reduce cost** and also suggested that we need more direction about the parking as we do not have engineering plans for parking. Adding additional small structures may be challenging if there are changes to where parking may be.
- Walmart grant - Feb 26. **Amber has applied**
- Costco grant, **Amber is looking into applying**
- Letter distribution for Fundraising: Susan had spoken with finance tonight. **They have asked us to pause this at this point.** They want to clarify that there is not a cap on the amount. Susan is hoping for clarity soon (later this week). Ashley voiced that we are open to feedback for the letter as we want this campaign to be successful in creating a great playground for the kids and building community.
- Feedback so far from those reviewing letters are: We cannot provide a plaque for thank you and to change language to "Outdoor play" instead of playground to cover more ground.
- **Bronwyn willing to fill envelopes with letters if needed.**

8:10 - 8:30 **Parking Concerns**

- Request to discuss parking and street safety around school
- Reviewed current parking around the city
- Patricia is more narrow since construction and there were concerns about buses getting through.
- In response the city has planned changes for parking. Proposal to create no stopping restrictions during school hours (Monday-Friday 8AM-4:30 PM) on South side of Patricia from Spadina. This will reduce 9 permit only spaces
- Citizens in area have been given a letter from city about upcoming changes, JFC did not receive letter from city.
- Susan provided map with current state of parking.
- Bronwyn has spoken with some concerned parents who rely on driving to drop off and pick up kids from school

- Suggestion is to have 15-30 minute parking exceptions for Spadina and North by the school or could the city provide permit for parents of students
- Bronwyn will write a communication and circulate to council for feedback.
- Christina has connection at city and it was suggested for letter to be emailed to city contact Connor and the connected councillor Debbie Chapman
- Susan asked to reduce the number of meetings as the April/May meetings are only 2 weeks apart and it is a busy time for staffing schedules. Susan stated that the council could still meet as a sub committee but without administration present.
- The council chose to cancel the April 13 meeting.

Next Meetings: **April 13 (cancelled)**, May 4, June 1

The following is the Principal Report that was not given due to time constraint. The following was emailed to Council post meeting to add to minutes:

- Black Brilliance Assembly wrap up Black History Month had an amazing assembly that showcased art pieces inspired by Black artists, music from the Kodaly choir and from our French music mania that represent Black artists and culture. Our theme being Ubuntu- 'I am what I am because of who we all are'.
- Board supports for reading and math: ERRT and Math Facilitator
- Math facilitator working with grade 6 with tier 3 support working on fractions and starting to work with grade 3 classrooms
- ERRT-working with Kindergarten classrooms to support literacy with the implementation of UFLI, and is supporting a grade 3 classroom to use Lexia supports and engage in small group instruction
- Staff engaged in a variety of professional learning opportunities: Using Lexia, Tiered Math Support, Indigenous Education, KIndergarten literacy instruction
- EDI is being completed by kindergarten teachers
- Acadience: Second Screening Window recently closed - second early reading screening completed for students who did not meet benchmark from first early reading screening. Information from screening is used to inform next steps in instruction for students
- Learning Lab was set up with the support of our central teams at the board-this continues to run daily to support our youngest learner in preparing for grade 1 with early school skills thank you to our amazing SERT team and EAs
- We will be practicing our lock down drill this week. We have a our spring tornado drill and fire drills planned once the weather is better
- Parking-still no updates on our school plan for upgrading our parking. We need to wait until the plans come back from the engineers before we are able to share more details
- Parking in the area-our transportation has a document that provides parking spaces that are on the streets and within walking distance.
- No other communication has been provided to the school regarding parking in the city.
- EQAO window: May 5–June 9, 2026
- EQAO family supports: All About Primary and Junior Assessments Upcoming Webinar, Reading Upcoming webinar, Writing Upcoming Webinar, Math Upcoming Webinar, Sample Tests